



Changing ruler units

4.2 Basic Drawing

Using the Drawing toolbar—usually located at the bottom of the Draw window—you can draw basic shapes such as lines, boxes, and circles. In order to draw a line, just select the line tool and hold down the left mouse button, and drag your cursor between the points you want to join with the line. It's just as easy to draw ellipses and boxes.

In order to draw a line that's vertical or horizontal, hold down [Shift] while drawing it—a little mouse skill is needed, however, because holding down [Shift] and dragging at, say, 40 degrees to an axis will draw a line at 45 degrees to it. Basically, holding down [Shift] draws lines at angles that are multiples of 45 degrees. Holding [Shift] down and drawing a box results in a square—and a circle when you use the ellipse tool.

If it is easier for you to draw starting from centre points rather than corners, hold down [Alt] and then drag the mouse—this results in a line, box, or ellipse being drawn from the centre out. If you hold down [Ctrl], the shapes you draw snap to the grid-lines. If you keep [Ctrl] pressed and click on one of the drawing tools, a default shape is placed on the drawing area. So if you want to create an ellipse, just hold [Ctrl] and click on the ellipse but-